Firdaws Alnuur Mohammed

Nairobi, Kenya | +254 743 712 626 | firdawsalnuur4@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity-focused Informatics and Computer Science graduate from Strathmore University with hands-on experience in threat detection, vulnerability assessment, systems security, and enterprise IT environments. Experienced in developing machine learning-based detection solutions, conducting web application security assessments, and analysing security incidents. Additional experience includes VAPT, log analysis, and systems audit.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Informatics & Computer Science | Strathmore University | Nairobi, Kenya | *Graduated Aug 2026*

Coursework: Computer Security & Cryptography, Computer Networks, Operating Systems, Database Systems, Artificial Intelligence, Distributed Systems, Information Technology & Security Design

Cybersecurity Training Program | International Cybersecurity & Digital Forensics Academy (ICDFA) | Remote | *2026 – 2027*

Courses: Network Defense, AWS Cloud Security Engineering, Python Essentials 1 & 2, AWS Machine Learning & Threat Detection, Identity and Access Management.

TRAINING & COURSEWORK

Introduction to MLSecOps	*LinkedIn Learning | Sep 2026*
AWS Academy: Machine Learning for Natural Language Processing	*AWS Academy | Aug 2026*
AWS Academy: Machine Learning Foundations	*AWS Academy | May 2026*
AWS Academy: Cloud Security Foundations	*AWS Academy | May 2026*
Network Defense	*Cisco Networking Academy | May 2026*
Python Essentials 1 & 2	*Cisco Networking Academy | Apr 2026*
Introduction to Cybersecurity	*Cisco Networking Academy | 2024*
CCNAv7: Switching, Routing, and Wireless Essentials	*Cisco Networking Academy | 2023*
CCNAv7: Introduction to Networks	*Cisco Networking Academy | 2022*
DevNet Associate (course)	*Cisco Networking Academy | 2022*

WORK EXPERIENCE

System Engineer | Cloudlogic Limited | Nairobi, Kenya | *Aug 2026 – Present*

- Conduct Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT) across web applications, networks, and Application, identifying vulnerabilities and security weaknesses.
- Perform systems and security audits, assessing configurations, access controls, data protection measures, and overall security posture.
- Configure and review FortiGate and Sophos firewalls, including firewall rules, access controls, and network security configurations.
- Document security findings and provide risk-based remediation recommendations to support clients in strengthening their security posture.

Cybersecurity Intern | Brainwave Matrix Solutions (Cybersecurity Consultancy) | Remote | *May 2025 – Jun 2025*

- Engineered a Python/YARA malware detection framework to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs), reducing manual triage time for security analysts.
- Built and deployed a phishing URL classifier (Random Forest) trained on 10,000 URLs, achieving 85.2% detection accuracy directly applicable to financial fraud and business email compromise (BEC) detection.
- Integrated external threat intelligence feeds to enrich detection context, supporting proactive threat hunting aligned with NIST CSF Detect function.
- Reduced false positive rate through iterative feature engineering and model validation, improving alert fidelity for SOC workflows.

IT Analyst Intern | Vivacom Ltd | Nairobi, Kenya | *Feb 2025 – Apr 2025*

- Performed web application vulnerability assessments using OWASP ZAP and Burp Suite, identifying OWASP Top 10 risks including injection and broken authentication flaws relevant to online banking platforms.
- Investigated and documented security incidents using Splunk and Wazuh SIEM, correlating log events to support root cause analysis and incident response reporting.
- Contributed to network security audits and firewall rule review, assessing controls against internal security policy requirements.

Cyber Security Intern | Future Interns | Remote | *Jan 2025 – Feb 2025*

- Supported cybersecurity incident management activities, including threat detection, initial triage, and investigation across a collaborative remote SOC environment.
- Applied SOC workflows and defensive security principles; documented threat assessment findings for team review.

PROJECTS

Active Directory & Windows Networking Lab | Windows Server 2019, PowerShell, AD DS, DNS, DHCP, NAT | *Jan 2026*

- Designed and built an isolated enterprise-style Active Directory environment using Oracle VirtualBox with a dual-NIC Domain Controller and internal client network.
- Configured AD DS, DNS, DHCP, and Routing/NAT on Windows Server 2019; designed static IP addressing and DHCP scopes for internal communication.
- Automated provisioning of 1,000+ domain users using PowerShell scripts with structured Organizational Units (OUs), mirroring enterprise IAM processes used in financial institutions.
- Validated centralized authentication, DNS resolution, and DHCP lease assignments across joined Windows 10 clients.

Vulnerability Management Lab | Nessus Essentials, Windows 10, VMware Workstation | *Feb 2026*

- Designed and executed a full vulnerability management lifecycle credentialed scanning, risk-prioritized remediation, and post-remediation verification mirroring regulated financial environment processes.
- Identified and remediated critical and high-severity vulnerabilities on a Windows 10 endpoint, reducing attack surface by removing deprecated software and applying security patches.
- Simulated real-world vulnerability exposure scenarios to test detection depth, demonstrating risk-based remediation aligned with PCI-DSS patch management controls.

Malware Research Lab:Keylogging & Detection | C#, .NET, Windows Internals, Malware Analysis | *Jan 2026*

- Analyzed a custom C# keylogging application in a controlled lab environment, studying keystroke capture behavior, log storage, and SMTP exfiltration.
- Tested antivirus detection fidelity using VirusTotal; compared signature-based vs. behavior-based detection methodologies and documented defensive indicators.

ARP Poisoning — Incident Response Lab | Wireshark, ARP, Incident Response | 2026

- Simulated an ARP poisoning incident and performed network traffic analysis, attack-vector identification, incident investigation, and mitigation documentation.

EXTRA ACTIVITIES

Mastercard Cybersecurity Virtual Experience | Forage | Remote | *Jan 2026*

- Served as an analyst on Mastercard's Security Awareness Team simulation; identified business units with security training gaps and designed targeted training procedures.

Cybersecurity Club, Strathmore University | Participated in CTFs, bootcamps, and cybersecurity awareness programs; collaborated on peer-led workshops.

SKILLS & KEYWORDS

Security & Compliance: Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Incident Response, Threat Detection, Log Analysis, SIEM, SOC Operations, IAM, GRC, PCI-DSS, NIST CSF, ISO 27001, OWASP Top 10, Patch Management, Endpoint Security, Business Email Compromise (BEC)

Tools: Nessus Essentials, OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, Wazuh, Splunk, Wireshark, Nmap, Active Directory, Linux, Windows Server, Snort , Gobuster, Nikto, tcpdump, Metasploit, BloodHound, Hydra, Microsoft Sentinel, Suricata, Autopsy, TheHive, Shodan, and OpenSSL.

Programming: Python (YARA, scikit-learn, ML pipelines), C#, JavaScript, PHP, C++, Node.js, PowerShell, React Native